

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Evacuation with access or mobility needs

EVACUATION SHELTER / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Plan movement around the person who needs the most assistance. Keep mobility aids, medicines, communication tools and essential care supplies together. Confirm accessible transport and a suitable destination directly; do not assume a shelter, lift or public rescue vehicle will be available.

Do now.

- ☐ **Identify the actual assistance**
01 Write down transfer needs, walking distance, stairs, powered devices, communication needs and care routines. Ask the person what help is safe and useful.
- ☐ **Check the route**
02 Assess exits and stairs before a crisis. Do not use lifts in a fire or damaged building, and do not improvise a dangerous carry.
- ☐ **Confirm support**
03 Arrange more than one trusted helper and transport option. Make the responsibility specific rather than assuming someone else will come.
- ☐ **Keep essential equipment close**
04 Include medicines, charger, batteries, mobility aids and a concise care note. Keep a portable backup where possible.
- ☐ **Verify the destination**
05 Ask about step-free entry, toilets, charging, refrigeration, caregivers and service animals. A general promise of accessibility is not a confirmed arrangement.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use your confirmed private support network and a destination suited to care needs. If transport cannot be arranged, identify the safest available refuge and communicate the precise assistance required through a safe channel.

Watch for.

Do not separate a person from essential equipment or a necessary caregiver if avoidable. An untrained lifting attempt can injure both the person and the helper.

People & practical needs.

Practice the route using the actual mobility and communication aids. Keep chargers, essential medicines and written instructions together. Ask the person what works for them before moving them or their equipment.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Practise the plan with the person's consent and revise it when equipment or care needs change. Keep an alternative plan for power loss and an unavailable caregiver.

Questions in the field.

What specific assistance is required?

Describe actions rather than only a diagnosis: stairs, transfers, communication, oxygen, charging, medication or a service animal. Make this information available to a trusted helper without publishing private medical details.

What if the planned helper cannot come?

Identify a second reachable support option and a safe waiting location suited to the hazard. Check it directly when possible. A generic shelter label does not establish accessibility, medical capability or permission to bring needed equipment.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[Ready.gov](#) · [People with disabilities](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/people-disabilities>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/accessible-evacuation/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.